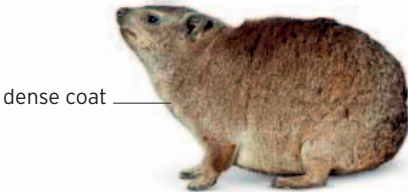




Rock hyrax

Procavia capensis



The tiny, tail-less rock hyrax makes its den in crevices and cavities in rocky outcrops or cliffs, which offer protection from predators such as leopards, snakes, and eagles. Rocks also help hyraxes to regulate their body temperature by providing basking places in cold weather and shade in hot conditions. The moist, rubberlike

soles of their feet enable hyraxes to climb with ease. Despite their thick coats, hyraxes are sensitive to temperature extremes, avoiding cold winds and rain as well as midday heat. A typical day begins with an hour or two of sunbathing, followed by an hour's foraging, then resting before feeding again in the afternoon.



↔ 12–23 in (30–58 cm)

⚖ 7–11 lb (3–5 kg)

⊗ Common

🌿 All vegetation

🏠

W., S., and E. Africa, W. Asia

◁ **GROUP HUDDLE**
Young hyraxes stay close to their mother. After resting together in the sun, this family is getting ready to resume feeding.



Arabian partridge

Alectoris melanocephala

This is a bird of vegetated wadis, valleys, high slopes, and cultivated desert fringe, especially scrubby juniper forest. Currently common, the Arabian partridge is threatened by droughts and changes in its habitat caused by cultivation and overgrazing. It escapes predators by running rather than flying. Most feeding and drinking takes place in the cooler morning and evening. Females lay five to eight eggs in a nest hidden in low vegetation.

↔ 16–17 in (40–43 cm)

⚖ 18–20 oz (500–570 g)

⊗ Common

🌿 Seeds, grass, small insects

🏠

SW. Asia

▷ **UNIQUE APPEARANCE**
A neat, pale, red-legged bird of dry places, the Arabian partridge has a distinctively striped head and neck.

